

No Money, No Honey

The notion that money buys love can be a very real perception. If a person has low self-esteem, they may feel that their net worth makes them a more desirable person. While playing the dating game, one's profession is definitely either an asset or a liability for many people. Especially if women are looking for a "provider," they may be drawn to someone who can financially take care of them. Since "How much money one makes" can be a strong factor in choosing a mate for some people, it is easy to make the assumption that this aspect is equally important for everyone.

Frank, a twenty-three-year-old computer engineer, came into the office for his credit counseling session and listed twenty-five credit cards on his application. Frank's income was high since his profession was in such demand. Because he earned so much, he had been able to make the minimum payments on all of his cards, which incidentally had very generous credit limits. Now, three years after he had started to accumulate this debt, Frank finally reached the point where he was so overextended he couldn't manage the payments anymore.

He was an extremely smart man who was living way beyond his means. The counselor discovered when going over his budget that Frank did not spend a lot of money. However, his girlfriend Ruth definitely had no problems spending Frank's money. The counselor suggested an honest discussion with Ruth to ask that she cut down on her spending. Frank refused to even consider the suggestion. When the counselor asked why, he replied, "I'm a computer geek. If I tell my girlfriend to stop spending she'll leave me and I'll never find another girlfriend."

The counselor encouraged Frank to be honest with Ruth. Frank was just assuming that his girlfriend was with him for his money. If she really did love him, money shouldn't matter. Frank should give Ruth an opportunity to prove his fears wrong.

